CLASS 3:
BUILDING IT.

A spec, a build route, and numbers that work.

SECTION 01

HOW YOU'LL BUILD IT

01

WHAT A TEAM USED TO COST

FIFTEEN PEOPLE, THEN.

01
RESEARCHER
AI reads reviews, pulls data, clusters complaints.

02
PM
AI writes the spec, tracks decisions in a ledger.

03
DESIGNER
AI generates layouts, tests variations.

04
DEVELOPER
AI writes and reviews the code.

05
QA
AI runs tests, catches regressions.

06
WRITER
AI drafts copy, docs and emails in your voice.

One person and AI now. The work didn’t disappear, the headcount did.

PICKING YOUR RUNG

WHAT DECIDES.

01

SPEED

Lovable ships a landing page in minutes. Claude Code ships a backend in a day.

02

CONTROL

App builders choose the stack. Coding with AI means you choose.

03

COST

A workflow costs API calls. A full build costs weeks.

04

HOW GOOD IT HAS TO BE

A prototype can look rough. A product people pay for can't.

RULE **Climb one rung at a time. Most products never need the top.**

NO CODE BACKGROUND

HOW I BUILD.

01
AI WRITES IT

→

02
A SECOND MODEL CHECKS IT

→

03
I DECIDE

I'm not a developer. The spec is how I stay in charge.

SECTION 02

THE SPEC

02

WHAT IT FILLS IN FOR YOU

IF YOU DON'T DECIDE, AI DECIDES.

AUTH	you wrote nothing →	Email and password login. No SSO, no magic link.
DATA MODEL	you wrote nothing →	Every field a string. No validation.
PRICING	you wrote nothing →	A free tier with no limits.

RULE **Every gap is a decision you didn't know you made.**

ONE PAGE, NOT TWENTY

WHAT THE SPEC HOLDS.

01 WHAT IT DOES

02 WHO IT'S FOR

03 THE PAID FEATURE

04 OUT OF SCOPE

05 LOCKED RULES

06 HOW YOU KNOW IT WORKS

RULE Out of scope is the half people skip.

THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES

EMPTY SCREEN, A BLINKING CURSOR.

“Start typing.” No sample data, no example, no guide.

They close the tab.

THE FIRST OUTPUT IS THE PRODUCT

THEIR DATA, ALREADY LOADED.

One good result before they do anything. Sources shown, output editable.

They stay.

For an AI product, the first run decides everything.

A SPEC FOR AN AI FEATURE

FOUR THINGS A NORMAL SPEC SKIPS.

01

A GOOD OUTPUT

What it looks like, written down.

02

COST PER USE

03

WHEN IT'S WRONG

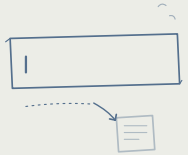
What the user sees.

04

EXAMPLES YOU'D ACCEPT

Those examples become your test set.

TRY THIS PROMPT



> Read my spec as a developer who’s never spoken to me. List every place you’d have to guess, and what you’d assume. Quote the line each time.

WATCH FOR **Use a different model from the one that wrote it.**

FACTORY

THE LEAD PIPELINE SPEC.

v2.0 · CLAUDE.md · 1 page

`SEND_ENABLED=false` `UNKNOWN is never PASS` `spend nothing until proven`

01

WHAT IT WILL NOT DO

- × No paid lead databases
- × No auto-sending
- × No LinkedIn or Instagram automation
- × No custom UI. The Sheet is the interface

02

THE RULE, DAY ONE

Every lead keeps the source it came from.

```
EmailProvenance: required
no source → not in the Sheet
```

FUNNEL, ESTIMATED

50,000	35,000	10,500	4,200	3,150	1,575	630	315	~160
domains	age 2y+	DTC + category	£40+	no blockers	variant depth	unit volume	LLM judgment	leads

SECTION 03

KEEPING AI ON TRACK

03

WHY IT DRIFTS

IT STARTS EVERY SESSION EMPTY.

01 It reads everything again, every turn. Long chats lose the middle.

02 Summaries soften decisions. By message 40 it’s undoing message 5.

RULE **A fresh chat plus your docs beats a long thread.**

YOUR MANAGEMENT LAYER

THREE DOCUMENTS, NOT MEETINGS.



01
THE SPEC

What we're building, and what we're not.

WITHOUT IT

AI builds the average product.

02
THE LEDGER

Every decision, dated, with the reason.

WITHOUT IT

Session 5 undoes session 2.

03
LOCKED RULES

Lines AI must not cross.

WITHOUT IT

Deleted features come back.

Paste all three at the start of every session.

RIGHTED

THE BUTTON THAT CAME BACK.

01	DELETED IT	I removed a feature from the spec and told AI to take it out.
02	IT RETURNED TWICE	Two sessions later AI rebuilt it — matching the old spec in its training, not my new one.
03	EVERY TEST PASSED	The tests checked whether the code worked. None checked whether the decision still held.

WATCH FOR **Tests check the code. Only your locked rules check the decisions.**

AGENTS THAT WORK LIKE YOU

DELEGATE THE LOOP, NOT THE CALL.

IT DOES

Reads the docs, does the task, checks against the spec.

YOU DO

Approve, reject, and update the ledger.

EXAMPLE · THE WEEKLY IDEA SCAN FROM CLASS 2

IT DOES Reads the context, generates five ideas, checks against past weeks, saves the output.

YOU DO **Read, pick, or ignore.**

SECTION 04

THE NUMBERS

04

RIGHTED

78% OF THE COST, 11% OF THE CALLS.

01 We defaulted to frontier for everything.

02 Most of those calls were routine: formatting, classification, tagging.

03 We moved them down a tier. The bill dropped by two thirds. No visible change.

RULE **Model choice is a pricing decision, not a technical one.**

FOUR TIERS, FOUR PRICES

PICK THE CHEAPEST ONE THAT WORKS.

FRONTIER

`Claude Opus, GPT-5, Gemini 2.5 Pro`

Complex reasoning, spec review, anything where a wrong answer costs you.

~$10–15
per million input tokens

MID-TIER

`Claude Sonnet, GPT-5 mini, Gemini 2.5 Flash`

Most product features: the output goes to a user but the format is predictable.

~$1–4
per million input tokens

BUDGET

`Claude Haiku, GPT-5 nano, DeepSeek V3`

Classification, extraction, tagging, structured tasks at volume.

~$0.10–1
per million input tokens

LOCAL

`Llama, Mistral, Qwen`

Free per call, you pay for the server. High volume, privacy, offline.

$0
per call

Model names and prices change every few months. Check the pricing page the week you ship.

RULE **Start at the bottom. Move up only when the output fails.**

BEFORE YOU PRICE ANYTHING

WHAT ONE USER COSTS YOU.

01	CALLS PER USER PER MONTH	A light user makes 20. A heavy user makes 200.
02	COST PER CALL	Frontier $0.01–0.10+ · mid-tier $0.001–0.01 · budget under $0.001
03	THE HEAVY USER	10× the calls, 10× the cost. Price for this one, not the average.
04	A FREE TIER AT 1,000 SIGNUPS	**1,000 × 20 calls × $0.005 = $100 a month before anyone pays.**

Prices change monthly. Check the provider's pricing page the week you ship.

WHICH MODEL, WHICH JOB

THREE QUESTIONS, THEN PICK.

01 **IS IT THE CORE THING YOUR PRODUCT DOES?**
The task users pay for. A wrong output costs you a customer.
→ FRONTIER

02 **CAN YOU COMPROMISE A LITTLE AND NOBODY NOTICES?**
It matters, but the format is predictable or you can check the output before it ships.
→ MID-TIER

03 **IS IT SIMPLE, REPETITIVE, OR RARELY SEEN?**
Easy for AI, runs at volume, or most users never touch it.
→ BUDGET OR LOCAL

RULE **Start at the bottom. Move up only when the output fails.**

PRACTICAL

COST YOUR IDEA.

```
From my spec, estimate cost per user per month: calls
per user, tokens per call, current model prices. Show the
heavy user separately. Ask me for anything you need instead
of assuming.
```

WHAT DOES ONE USER COST?

WATCH FOR It will guess prices from training data. Check today's pricing page.

THREE WAYS TO CHARGE

PRICE FROM THE FLOOR UP.

01

SUBSCRIPTION

Steady, until a heavy user arrives.

02

USAGE

Safe for you, scary for them.

03

LIFETIME DEAL

Cash now, cost forever.

THE REAL CONSTRAINT

CAN TWO PEOPLE RUN IT?

01 Support, refunds, outages, abuse. All of it lands on you.

02 Every feature adds a thing that can break at 2am.

RULE If you can’t run it, don’t ship it.

SECTION 05 · WHERE IT GOES NEXT

PICK THE CHANNEL BEFORE YOU BUILD.

01

SEARCH AND AI ANSWERS

People search the problem, your product appears.

`AgentiSEO, Righted`

02

COMMUNITIES

Go where they already talk, be useful first.

`Reddit, Facebook groups, Indie Hackers`

03

OUTREACH

Find them one by one, message them.

`The lead machine`

04

MARKETPLACES

Someone else's audience, their rules.

`Feedboss on AppSumo`

05

CONTENT

Write what they search for. AI writes most of it.

`Feedboss LinkedIn engine`

The channel changes the product, the price and the spec. Next class goes deep on each one.

BEFORE NEXT CLASS

THREE THINGS.

01

THE SPEC

One page, with out of scope and locked rules.

02

A COST LINE

What one user costs, heavy user separately.

03

A CHANNEL GUESS

Where your first ten users come from.

NEXT CLASS: SELLING AND SCALING WITH ONE OR TWO PEOPLE.